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ARTICLE

America's Debt Bomb Is Not A Distant Threat - It Is Coming For Every Household



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BY PNW STAFF MAY 13, 2026

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There was a time when America's national debt dominated political debate. Politicians warned about deficits, economists sounded alarms, and voters at least vaguely understood that endlessly borrowing money carried consequences. Today, however, the debt crisis has become America's great unspoken emergency -- so massive, so overwhelming, and so politically inconvenient that many leaders barely discuss it at all.

But the numbers are becoming impossible to ignore.

The United States is now approaching an astonishing \$39 trillion national debt. Worse still, America is paying nearly \$3 billion every single day just to cover interest payments on that debt.

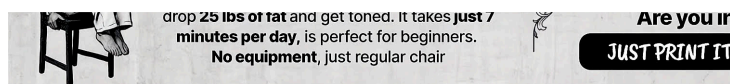
Not to pay the debt down.

Not to improve roads.

Not to strengthen schools.

Not to rebuild infrastructure.

Just interest.



According to the latest Congressional Budget Office data, the Treasury has already paid roughly \$628 billion in net interest costs during the first seven months of the fiscal year. That averages out to about \$2.96 billion every day flowing out of taxpayer pockets simply to service America's existing borrowing.

Pause for a moment and think about what that means.

Imagine a family drowning in credit card debt. Every month, they work harder and harder, but most of their paycheck no longer goes toward improving their lives. Instead, huge portions disappear into minimum payments and interest charges. They are no longer building wealth -- they are feeding the debt monster.

That is now the United States government.

And unlike a household, Washington has spent decades pretending the limits do not apply.

America has officially crossed a historic line where public debt now exceeds 100 percent of GDP, meaning the nation owes more than the entire economy produces in a year. The last time this happened was during World War II and briefly during the COVID emergency. The difference now is that this debt explosion is not tied to a temporary world war mobilization. It has become normal operating procedure.

The Congressional Budget Office warns the debt burden could rise to 120 percent of GDP within the next decade. At that point, America edges closer to the kinds of debt crises seen in nations like Greece and Argentina -- countries forced into painful economic contractions, inflation spirals, and crushing austerity.

Many Americans struggle to understand numbers this large because trillions do not feel real anymore. Washington throws the term around so casually that the scale gets lost.

So let's simplify it.



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America's debt now works out to roughly \$55,000 or more for every man, woman, and child in the country. A family of four is effectively carrying over \$220,000 in federal debt obligations before even factoring in mortgages, car loans, credit cards, or personal debt.

And that does not even include America's unfunded liabilities like Social Security and Medicare obligations, which some estimates place at over \$88 trillion.

That is the equivalent of a person promising retirement benefits they know they probably cannot fully afford decades from now.

The frightening part is not only the size of the debt -- it is how quickly interest payments themselves are swallowing the federal budget.

So far this fiscal year, America has spent:

\$953 billion on Social Security

\$588 billion on Medicare

\$409 billion on Medicaid

\$628 billion on interest payments alone

In other words, interest on the debt now costs more than Medicaid and even exceeds Medicare spending levels during this stretch of the fiscal year.

Think about how insane that is.

The United States government is now spending more money servicing old debt than funding massive healthcare programs relied upon by millions of Americans.

And the problem compounds itself. As interest rates remain elevated, borrowing becomes even more expensive. The Congressional Budget Office notes that interest costs rose another 7 percent this year largely because America's debt pile itself keeps growing.

It becomes a vicious cycle:

Borrow more money.

Pay more interest.

Borrow even more to cover the interest.

Repeat.

Eventually the cycle becomes mathematically impossible to sustain.



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Then there are the endless examples of absurd government spending priorities that leave ordinary taxpayers stunned.

Millions have been spent on bizarre studies, ideological campaigns, foreign activist programs, niche marketing efforts, and projects that feel completely detached from the struggles of working Americans trying to afford groceries, rent, or healthcare.

This is where public trust begins to collapse.

Americans can tolerate sacrifice during genuine emergencies. They can accept difficult economic realities if they believe leaders are being responsible stewards of taxpayer money. But what many citizens increasingly see is a political system addicted to spending with very little restraint, oversight, or long-term planning.

Even recent improvements in tariff revenue -- which reportedly surged over 220 percent year-over-year to \$190 billion -- barely scratch the surface of the larger problem. Yes, tariffs have temporarily boosted government income, and some economists believe future administrations from both parties may become dependent on that revenue stream. But tariffs alone cannot solve a debt crisis of this magnitude.

The truth is that America cannot tax, borrow, or print its way out forever.

Eventually, the consequences arrive in the lives of ordinary people.

Higher debt means higher inflation pressures. It means more expensive mortgages. Higher credit card rates. Reduced purchasing power. Slower wage growth. Greater pressure on retirement systems. A weaker dollar over time. Fewer opportunities for younger generations.

And unlike politicians, average Americans cannot simply vote themselves another trillion dollars.

There is still time for America to change course. The country remains enormously productive, innovative, and economically powerful. Advances in technology and artificial intelligence could boost productivity and help expand economic growth in the years ahead. But even optimistic growth projections cannot erase the reality that uncontrolled spending eventually collides with mathematical limits.

History has shown this repeatedly.

Empires rarely collapse overnight. More often, they slowly decay under the weight of financial irresponsibility, political corruption, public complacency, and leaders unwilling to make hard decisions.

That is why the national debt is not just an economic story.

It is a moral one.

Because every trillion borrowed today is a burden shifted onto future generations who never agreed to carry it.



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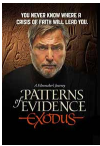
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